

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437

Respondents

180+

Countries

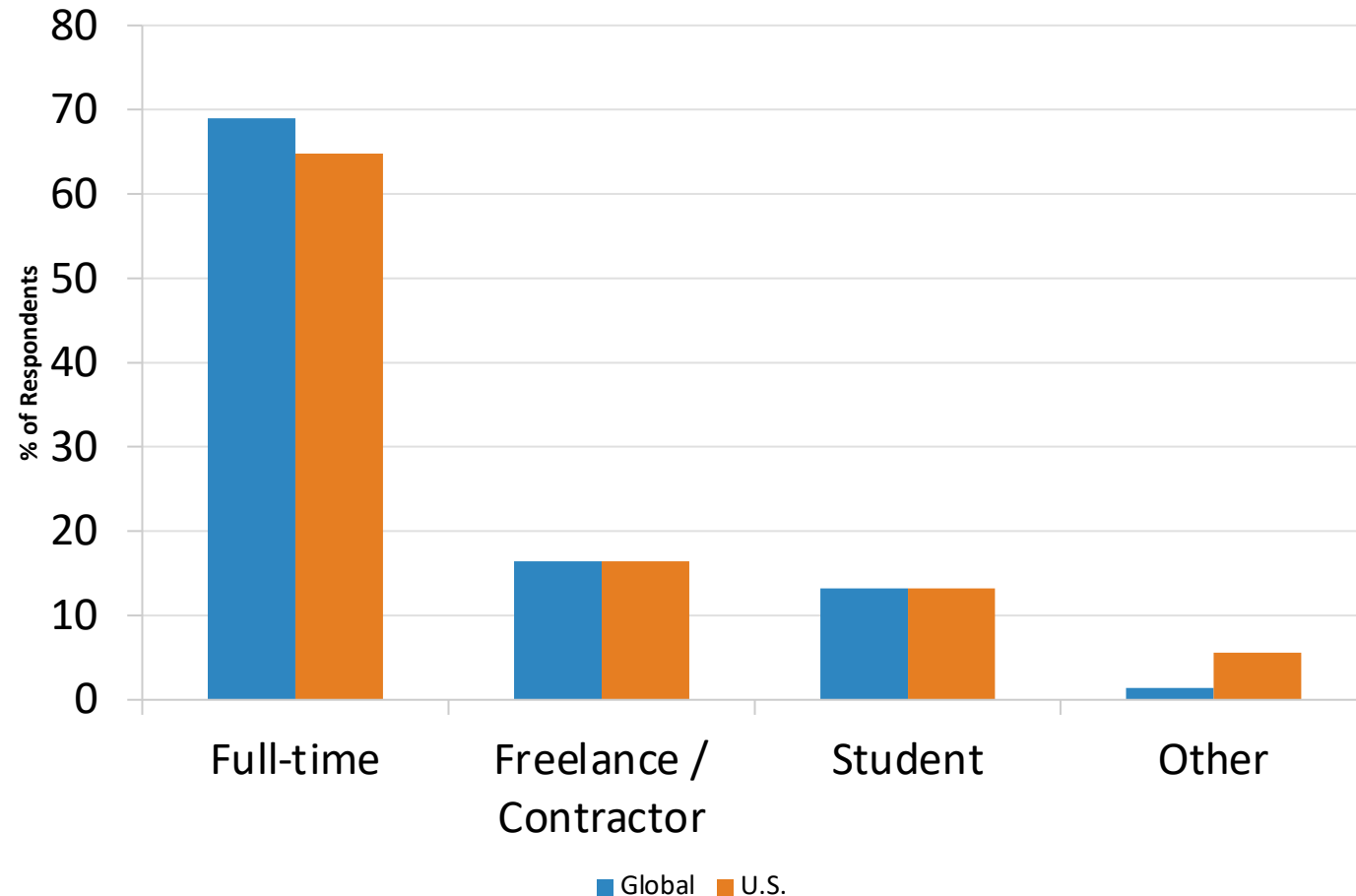
2024

Survey Year

Source: stackoverflow.co/survey/2024

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Employment status breakdown — global vs. United States



Key Finding

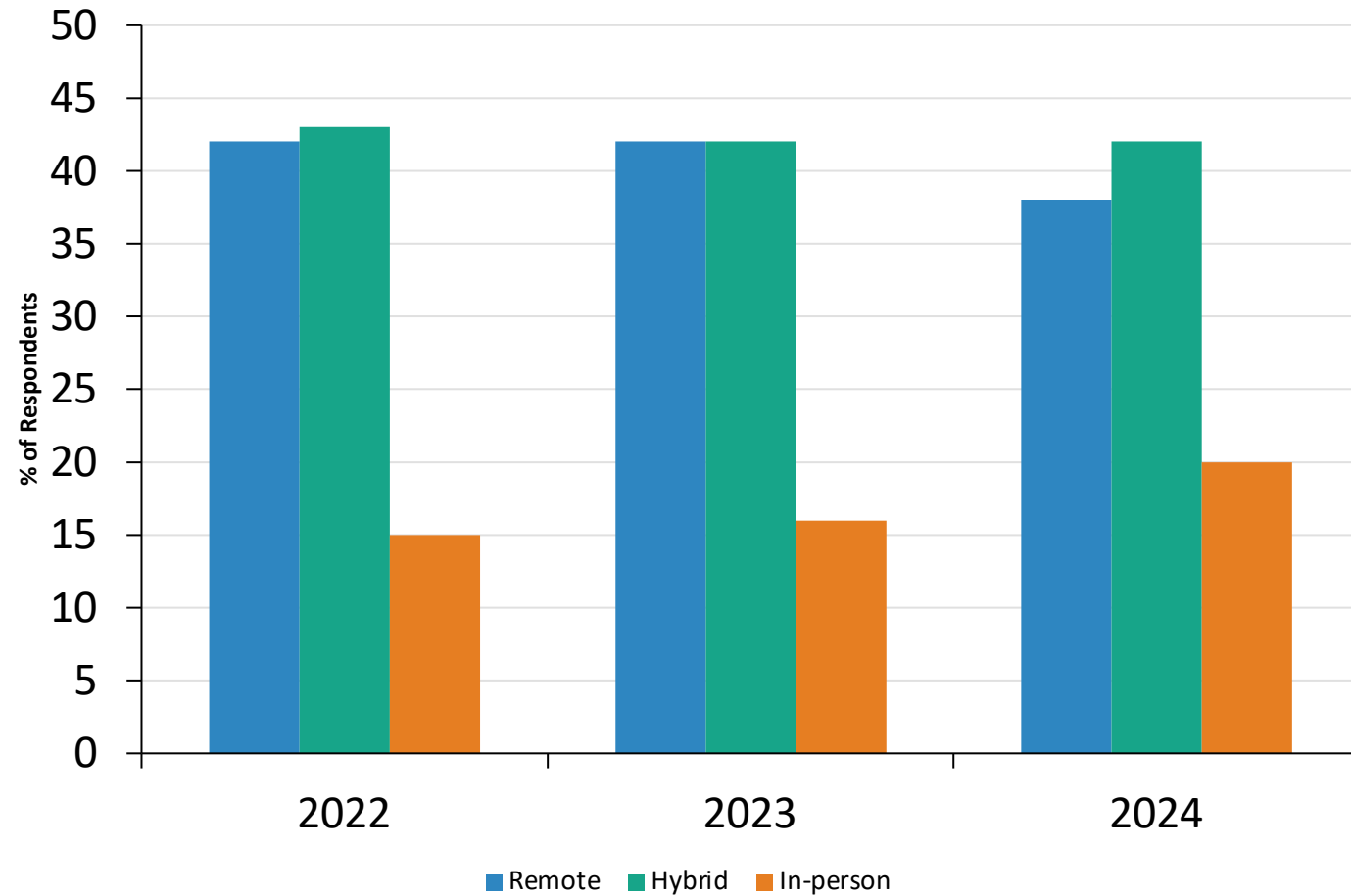
U.S. full-time employment dropped from 69% (2023) to 64.8% (2024) — a 4.2 pp decline. In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting; in Germany and India, they are more likely to be full-time students.

Implication

Full-time employment is softening. Plan for a growing contractor and freelance workforce and adjust hiring strategies accordingly.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Three-year trend in work arrangement (2022–2024)

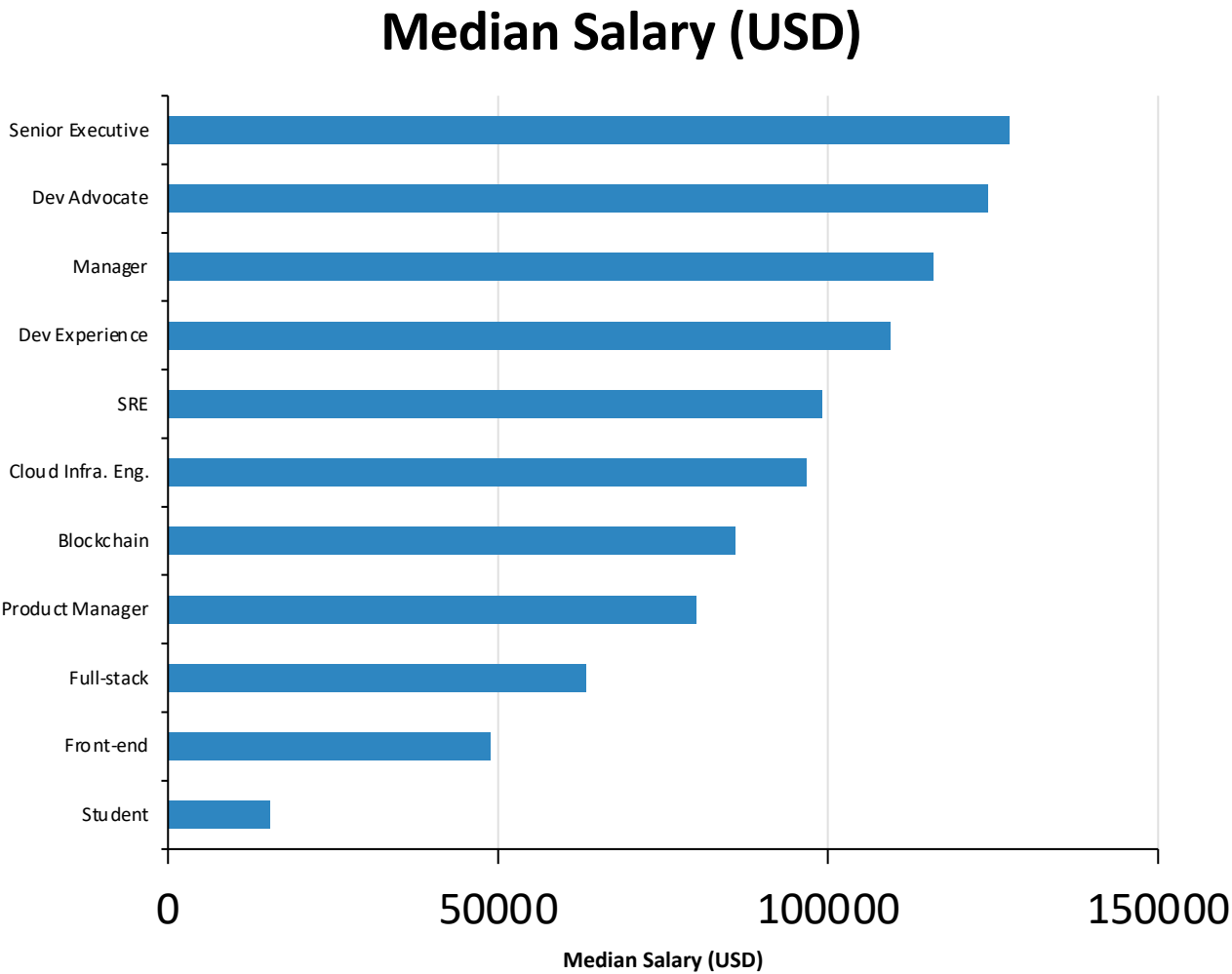


Trend Analysis

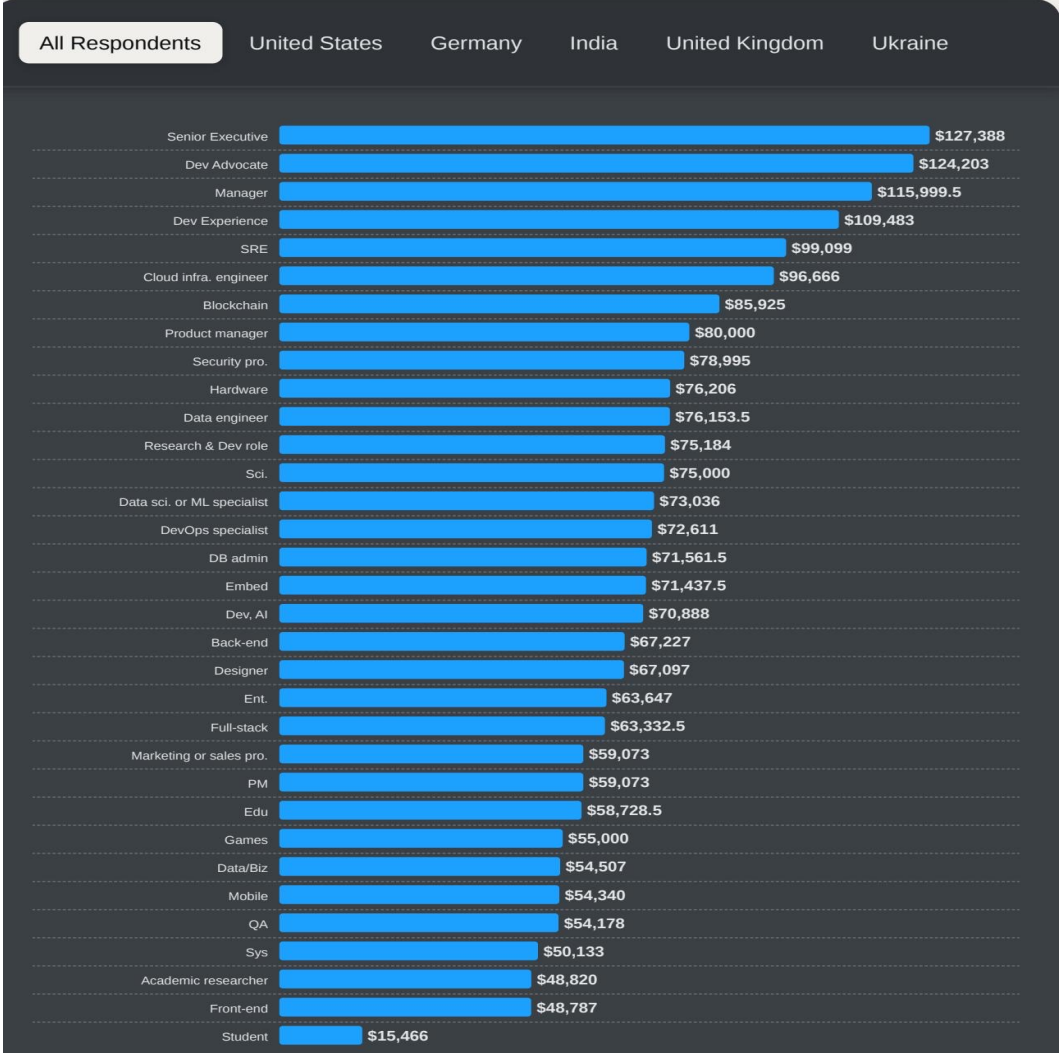
- In-person work has risen for the 3rd consecutive year: 15% → 16% → 20%
- Remote work declined from 42% to 38% over the same period
- Hybrid remains the dominant arrangement at 42%, flat since 2023
- The gradual return-to-office trend signals shifting employer expectations

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation by developer type — 22,677 salary responses



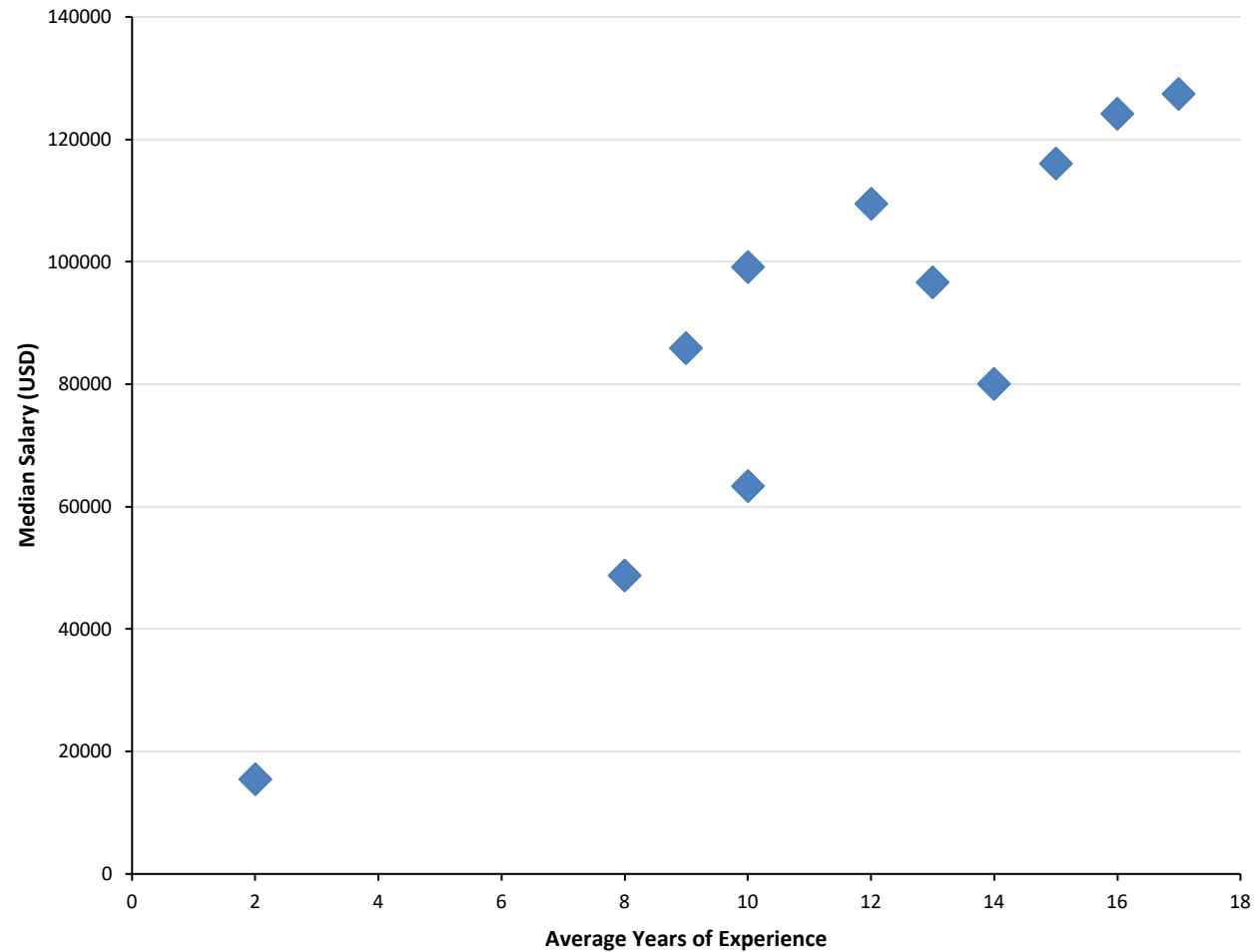
Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024 | [stackoverflow.co/survey/2024](https://stackoverflow.com/survey/2024)



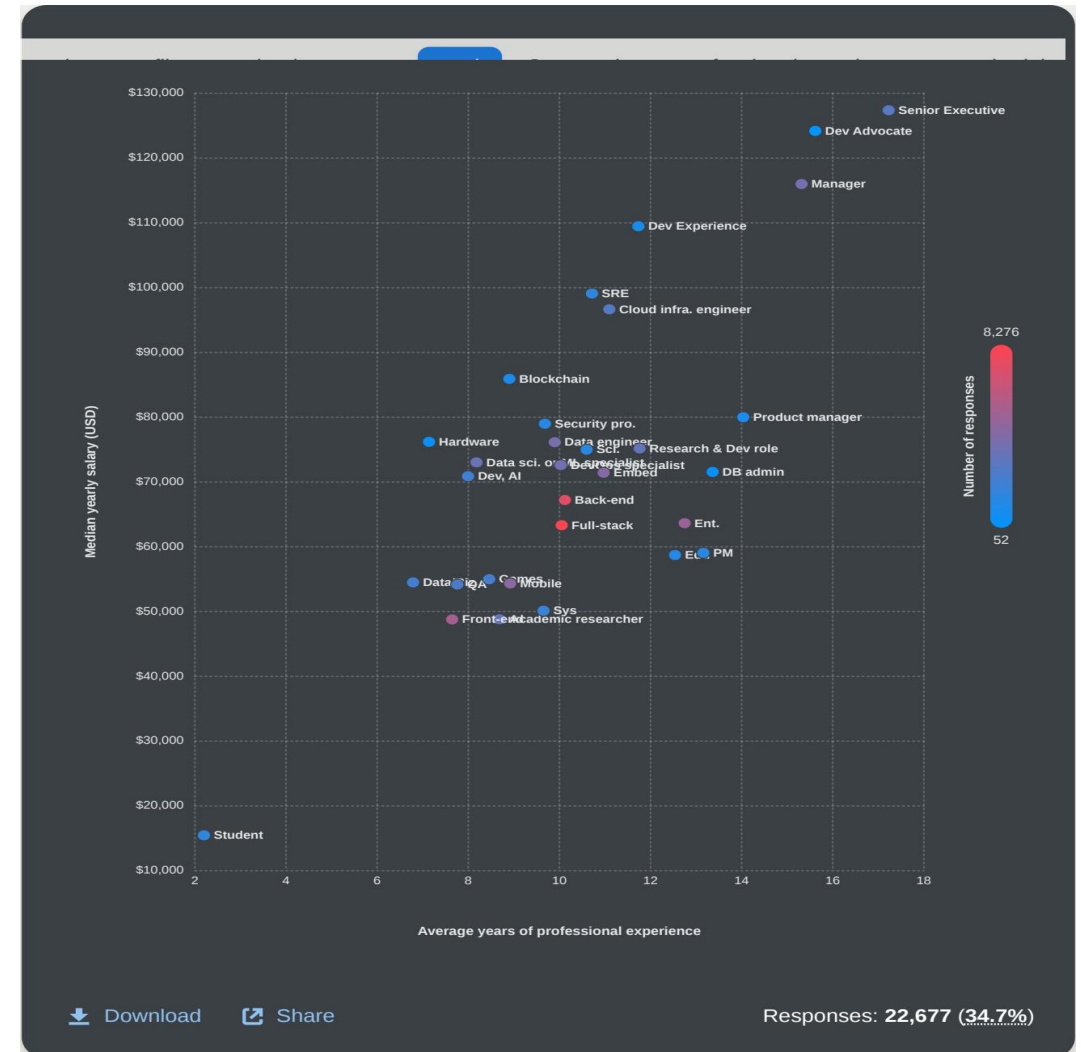
Source figure: Salary by developer type (figure_1.jpg)

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary vs. average years of experience by developer type



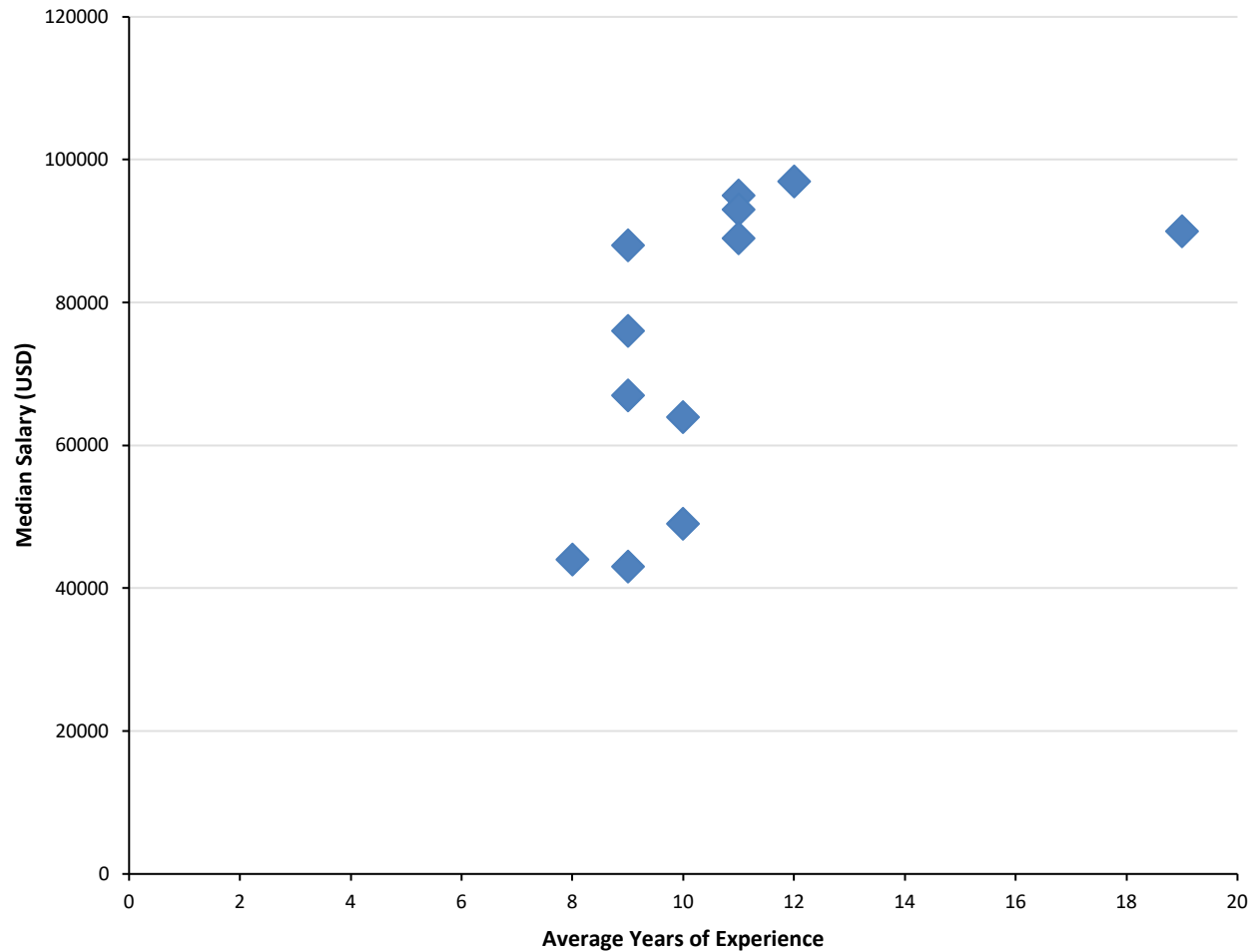
Source: Stack Overflow Developer Survey 2024 | stackoverflow.co/survey/2024



Source figure: Salary vs. experience by developer type (figure_2.jpg)

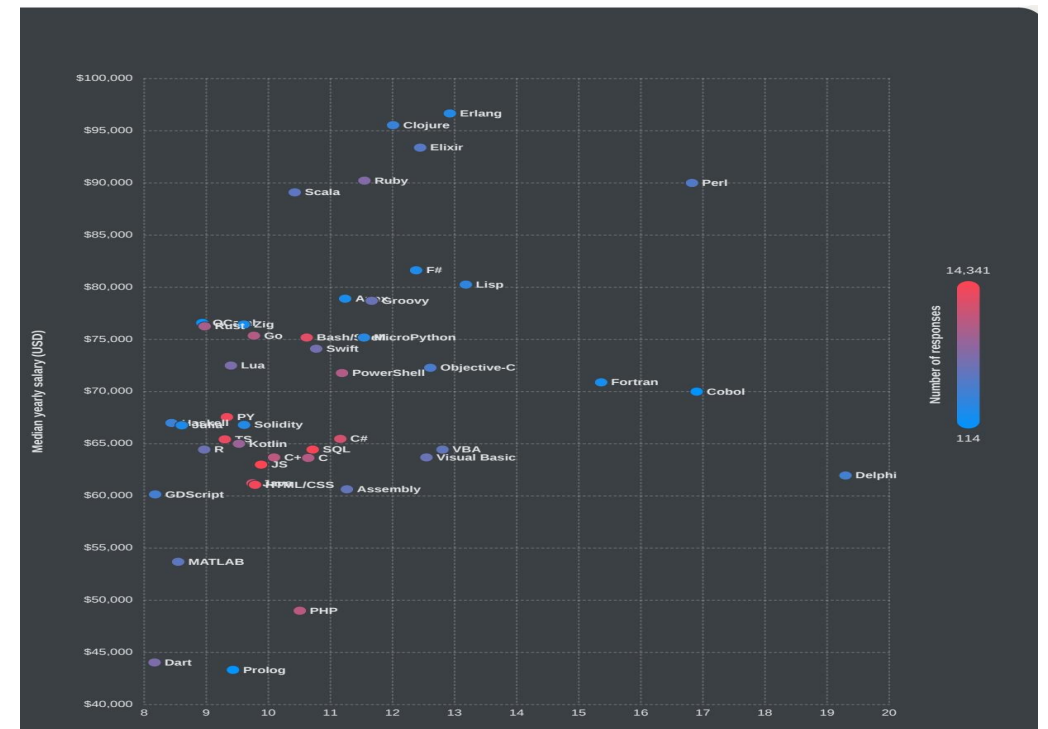
Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. average experience by programming language



Year-over-Year Decline

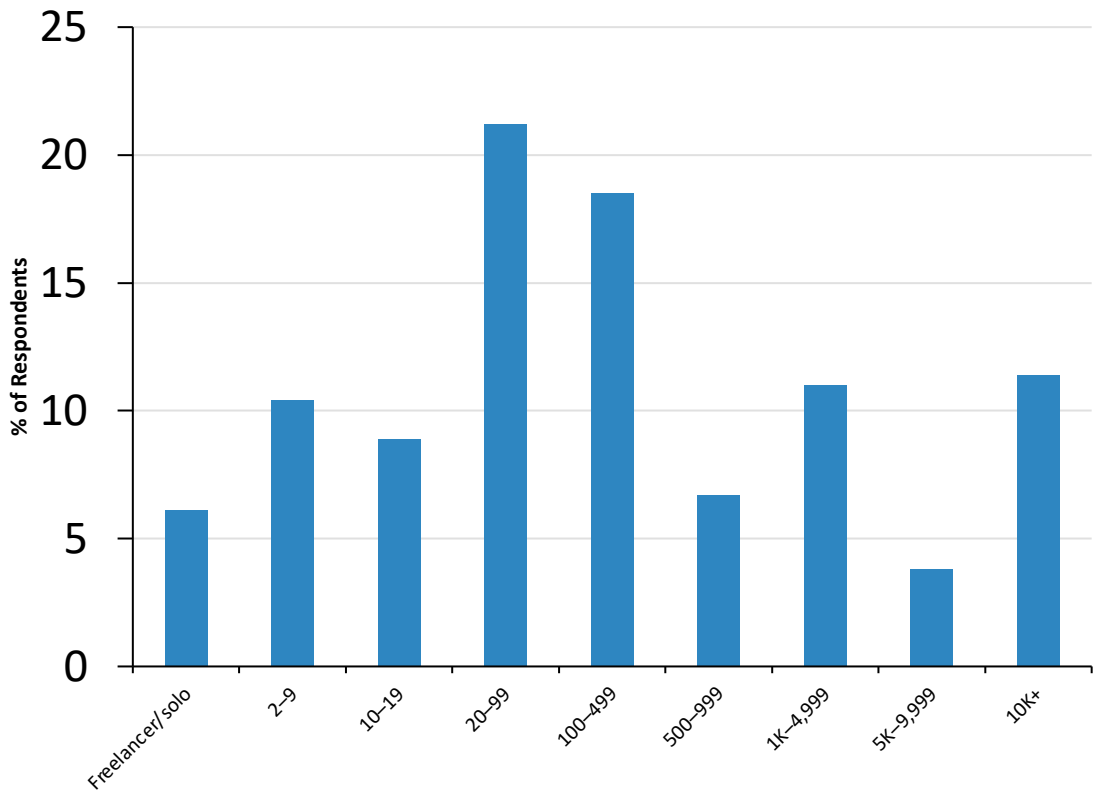
Overall reported salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 — now averaging \$60–75K USD vs. \$70–85K USD last year.



47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company size distribution and technology purchasing influence

Share of Respondents (%)



62%

of developers influence technology purchases

60%

prefer a build-and-buy approach

Top Purchase Influencers by Role

Role	Influence
Senior Executives	99%
Engineering Managers	87%
Product Managers	77%

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Actionable insights from the 2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

1

Full-time employment is softening

U.S. full-time employment fell 4 pp year-over-year; plan for a growing contractor and freelance workforce.

2

In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid still dominates

In-person rose from 15% to 20% over three years, yet 42% hybrid remains the most common arrangement — flexibility is still expected.

3

DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and SREs (\$99K) top the salary chart — budget accordingly for these competitive roles.

4

Niche languages correlate with higher pay

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median; mainstream languages like JavaScript (\$64K) and PHP (\$49K) sit well below.

5

Most developers influence tech purchasing

62% have a say in buying decisions; engage developers directly, not just management, in your go-to-market strategy.